

MAKSYM MUSHTA • MAKSYM STOLYAROV | INTRODUCTION TO GAME DESIGN

The idea

You wake up alone in an underground station.

The emergency system says the station shuts down in ten minutes. A voice on the radio says the announcement is lying.

Can you find a way out before the countdown reaches zero?

How you play

1. EXPLORE

Choose which area of the station to investigate.

2. DECIDE

Every action costs time and may reveal clues.

3. ESCAPE

Use what you found to reach an ending.

Core loop: Explore → Choose → Lose time → Discover → Escape

The countdown changes everything

10:00

- Search the control room: −1:30
- Follow the radio signal: −2:00
- Run straight to the exit: −1:00

There is not enough time to investigate every room. Players must prioritise.

Different choices, different endings

ESCAPE

Find the override code and get out before shutdown.

SAVE SOMEONE

Find the worker, learn the truth and escape together.

TOO LATE

Waste too much time or trust the wrong instructions.

A short story that players can replay to see what they missed.

Why this game?

- The countdown is part of the gameplay, not just decoration.
- Your choices affect both the remaining time and the story.
- Multiple endings encourage a second playthrough.
- Small scope: realistic to prototype as a two-person team.

Genre: branching mystery • Platform: web browser • Audience: story/puzzle fans

Style and players

LOOK & FEEL

PS1-inspired low-poly art / Dark station corridors / Red emergency lights / Radio messages

TARGET PLAYERS

People who like short mysteries, branching stories and making difficult decisions.

We plan a free browser game.

How we plan to make it

W1

Story & flowchart

W2

Choices & timer

W3

Art & UI

W4

Test & improve

Proposed Sprint 1: basic story, branching choices, countdown and portfolio.

Our team

MAKSYM MUSHTA

Proposed focus: programming, countdown system, portfolio website.

MAKSYM STOLYAROV

Proposed focus: story branches, level flow, visual direction and testing.

Both of us will plan, test and improve the game together.

What we need / next steps

We want to build a complete short playable story.

- Finish the prototype and test the story choices.
- Record our pitch and collect feedback.
- Use Trello to track the first sprint.
- Publish the game and progress on GitHub Pages.

PLATFORM ZERO — Your time is running out.